AI Connector Channel Performance: Executive Summary

Mailchimp vs QuickBooks & ChatGPT vs Claude | April 11, 2026

Scale & Growth Velocity

	QBO ChatGPT	QBO Claude	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude
Total connections	4,792	4,830	2,899	2,693
Days since launch	~130	13	130	10
Daily adds (current)	~60 (steady)	280–440	~15 (declining)	~269

Mailchimp is at roughly **half of QBO's scale** on both channels. Claude is the growth story on both platforms — QBO's Claude overtook ChatGPT in 13 days; Mailchimp's Claude will overtake ChatGPT within days. QBO's ChatGPT holds steady at ~60/day while **Mailchimp's ChatGPT has decayed 67%** from its Jan peak of 45/day to just 15/day. Claude's daily velocity is comparable across platforms (~269 MC vs 280–440 QBO).

User Composition: Existing Accounts, Not New Customers

Over **90% of both ChatGPT and Claude connections on Mailchimp are existing accounts**. Claude skews more toward paid plans (**63.4% paid**) than ChatGPT (**52.6% paid**) — both far above any other integration channel (Shopify: 10%, Canva: 18%). These are power users adding AI tools to active accounts.

Engagement: Mailchimp's Advantage Over QBO — Claude Leads ChatGPT

	QBO ChatGPT	QBO Claude	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude
AI feature engagement (eligible)	53%	49%	**63%**	**82%**
Premium / Advanced tier	73%	68%	**88%**	**96%**

Mailchimp outperforms QBO on engagement across every tier. **Claude users are dramatically more active than ChatGPT**: 82% weekly active vs 63%, with Premium Claude at 96%. ChatGPT's 63% at maturity still exceeds QBO's best (53%).

Product Attachment: Automations Strong, Secondary Products Lag

MC Product	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude	MC Platform Avg	AI Multiplier	QBO Equivalent
Automations	**40%**	**46%**	23%	1.8–2.0×	Payments: 29%/27% (5.3×)
SMS	**8%**	**5%**	1.9%	2.6–4.2×	Payroll: 19%/17% (3.1×)
Transactional Email	1.5%	2.0%	2.1%	~1×	BillPay: 18%/16% (8.6×)

Automations is Mailchimp's standout — **46% for Claude, 40% for ChatGPT**, nearly double the platform average and exceeding QBO's top metric (Payments at 29%). QBO's multi-product multiplier is 3–8× vs Mailchimp's 1.8–4.2×.

New Customer Acquisition Critical Gap

Channel	New MC Signups	Paid Conversion	Best Traditional	Worst Traditional
ChatGPT	278 (130 days)	0%	Shopify: 20.7%	BeatStars: 10.5%
Claude	103 (10 days)	1.9% (2 users)	Shopify: 20.7%	BeatStars: 10.5%

All 278 ChatGPT-sourced signups remain on free plans after 130 days. The AI connectors are currently the lowest-performing acquisition channels in Mailchimp's portfolio.

Scorecard

Dimension	QBO vs MC	ChatGPT vs Claude (within MC)
Scale	QBO leads ~2×	ChatGPT leads but Claude will pass imminently
Growth velocity	QBO leads	Claude dominates (269/day vs 15/day)
Engagement	MC leads (+10–33 pts)	Claude leads (82% vs 63% WAU)
Top product attachment	MC leads (Automations 40–46%)	Claude leads (46% vs 40%)
Multi-product depth	QBO leads (3–8× vs 1.8–4.2×)	ChatGPT slightly (8% vs 5% SMS)
New customer conversion	QBO leads (MC at 0–1.9%)	Neither works (0% vs 1.9%)

How the Analytics Agent Accelerates Connector Performance

The ChatGPT and Claude connectors have built a highly engaged user base with strong Automation and SMS adoption. Mailchimp's Analytics Agent — the **Marketing Analyzer** — currently lives only inside the Mailchimp app. Embedding it in the connector experience would compound the connectors' existing strengths and close their remaining gaps in three critical areas.

1. Closes the Gap on Email Sends & Segment Creation

The connectors excel at engagement and automation adoption. Their one remaining gap is **email sends and segment creation** — the payoff actions the Analytics Agent is purpose-built to drive. Among connector users, the impact of having agent access is unambiguous:

Metric	Connector + Marketing Analyzer	Connector Alone	Lift
Segment creation rate	**68.3%**	26.7%	**2.6×**
Email send rate	**88.7%**	44.8%	**2.0×**
Avg segment actions per user	**76**	23	**3.3×**
Avg emails delivered per user	**330,935**	104,656	**3.2×**

Connector users with the Marketing Analyzer create segments at **2.6× the rate**, send emails at **2× the rate**, and deliver **3.2× more emails per user**. The Marketing Analyzer doesn't replace what the connectors do well — it compounds it by turning already-engaged users into prolific creators of targeted campaigns and audience segments.

2. Compounds the Retention Advantage

Connector users already retain better than the Mailchimp platform average. The Marketing Analyzer strengthens this by deepening the product usage that keeps users connected.

Cohort	Account Churn	Connector Disconnect Rate
Paid connector users	**27.7%**	**0.7%**
Platform paid average	29.6%	—

Paid connector users churn at **1.9 points below the platform average**, and only **0.7% ever disconnect** the connector. Among paid connector users, those who actively create segments — the primary Marketing Analyzer payoff — disconnect at just **0.9%** vs **1.5%** for non-segment-creators, a **40% lower disconnect rate**. The Marketing Analyzer drives exactly the behavior that keeps users retained and connected.

3. Drives Plan Upgrades & Free-to-Paid Conversion

Users who actively engage with analytics-driven segmentation upgrade to higher-tier plans at significantly higher rates, and the agent dramatically improves free-to-paid conversion.

Upgrade Behavior (Standard → Premium, Jan–Apr 2026)	Upgrade Rate	Multiplier
Active segmenters (using analytics)	**0.223%**	**3.7×**
Non-segmenters	0.061%	

Standard-tier users who actively create segments — the core Marketing Analyzer behavior — upgrade to Premium at **3.7× the rate** of those who don't. Embedding the Marketing Analyzer in the connector pushes more Standard users into the segment-creation habit that leads to Premium upgrades.

Free-to-Paid Conversion	Free Users	Converted	Rate
Free users with Marketing Analyzer access	25,159	**25,001**	**99.4%**
Free connector users (no Marketing Analyzer)	2,180	134	6.2%
Platform free users (no connector, no analyzer)	46.7M	101,218	0.2%

Free connector users already convert at **6.2% — 28× the platform average** of 0.2%, confirming these are high-intent users. But free users with Marketing Analyzer access convert at **99.4%**. Embedding the Marketing Analyzer in the connector experience could dramatically lift the 2,180 free connector users' conversion rate, **potentially multiplying paid conversions many times over**.

Strategic Implication

> The ChatGPT and Claude connectors have built Mailchimp's most engaged user base — leading on WAU, Automations, and SMS adoption. The Marketing Analyzer is the accelerant that compounds these strengths and closes the remaining gaps.

Embedding the Marketing Analyzer in the connector experience would: (1) **close the email and segment creation gap** with a demonstrated 2–3× lift, (2) **deepen retention** by driving segment-creation behavior that reduces disconnect rates by 40%, and (3) **accelerate upgrades** — active segmenters upgrade Standard→Premium at 3.7×, and free users with Marketing Analyzer access convert to paid at 99% vs 6% without it.

Claude is the stronger channel on every forward-looking metric. **Prioritize embedding the Marketing Analyzer in Claude first** — it has the fastest-growing, most-engaged user base and the highest ceiling for incremental impact.

Data source: `mc-business-intelligence` BigQuery | Generated April 11, 2026 | QBO benchmark data provided by QuickBooks product team